

the same thing. This is the main GA view which you will use to analyze the overall performance of your site. Ensure that this view has all of the important filters applied. Some of them include internal traffic filters, spam exclusions, etc. The filters you choose to apply will depend on the business you are dealing with. As far as Google or third party products are concerned, this is the view that you should be using for all your custom reports and dashboards.

Raw View

Think of this as the unfiltered view. Set the most basic settings like the business name and change the timezone to the one you are in your business works out of. Avoid adding any other filters so that the data seen in this view is as free from manipulation as possible. This view is your backup. That's the only job it has. If you ever need to have a look at the data that is excluded in the Main View because of filters, this data here can be extremely helpful. And if in the worst case scenario, you have technical glitches with your Main View, you will need some data to fall back on.

Test View

Even though GA claims that it will take around 12 to 24 hours for the changes to show up in your data collected, it has been our experience that the effects of any and all new filters will almost always be directly visible in the GA data. It shows up under 'real time reporting', if nothing else. It is for this exact reason that we suggest starting off with this view so that you are not stuck with any bad data collected in any of the other views.

Test out a lot of new stuff with this view. You can play around with filters before you apply any of them to your Main View. You can apply a filter for this view, collect a little test data, check what the results look like and make sure that it works like you intended for it to. Once you are sure that it is in the clear, then you can add it to the Main View. Come to think of it, the settings you have in the Test View should be the same as the ones you will want to eventually apply to your Main View.

Business specific views

Once you have created the three must have views that we have covered in the previous section, the next most logical move will be to create views that are specific to your business type and your site. These business specific views will make life easier as far as insights are concerned. Think about it,